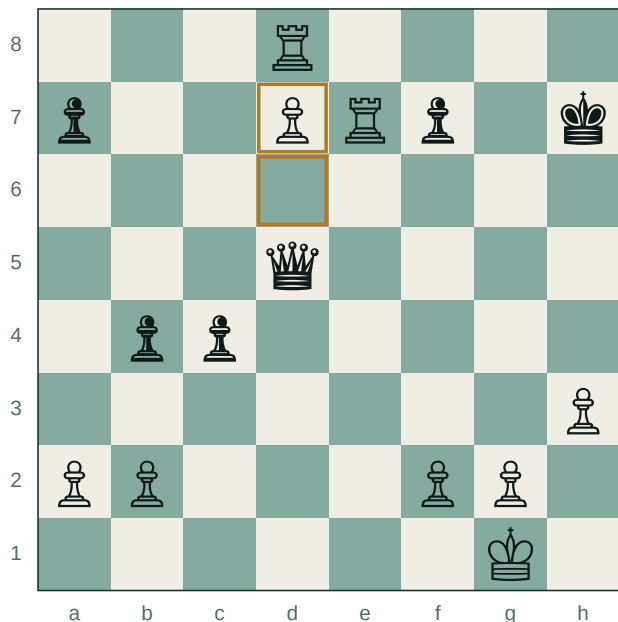


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 35

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 35.d7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Qd1+ 36. Kh2 Qd6+ 37. f4 Qxe7 38. Rc8 Qxd7

35...Qd1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36.Kh2**.

36...Qd6+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on h2 and rook on e7. Recorded reply: **37.f4**.

37...Qxe7 The queen captures the rook on e7. Recorded reply: **38.Rc8**.

38...Qxd7 The queen captures the pawn on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +6:** the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8 and rook on e7. Check for tactical protection.